

Postmortem INC-7891: checkout-api TLS certificate expiry

Date: January 2026. Duration: 54 minutes. Severity: SEV2.

Summary

Customers saw errors from checkout-api for 54 minutes. The trigger was TLS certificate expiry.

Timeline

09:12 alert fired. 09:20 incident declared. 09:57 mitigation applied.

Root cause

A change merged two days earlier removed a safety limit, so TLS certificate expiry was able to build up unnoticed until peak traffic. Monitoring did not alert early because the threshold was set for the old traffic pattern.

Contributing factors

- The runbook pointed to a dashboard that had been renamed.
- The canary stage was skipped for a config-only change.

Action items

- AI-396: restore the safety limit and add a regression test.
- AI-181: update the alert threshold to the new traffic pattern.
- AI-975: never skip the canary, including for config changes.